



Spanish 4 Honors

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADES 9–12 · FULL YEAR · 1 CREDIT · HONORS

~4¼ hrs per week · 50 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. This page is drawn from the Florida course description rather than a built Optima course, so the specific units, readings, and activities scholars see will be set by the teacher and may vary between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

Spanish 4 Honors expands the skills mastered in Spanish 3 into genuinely advanced territory: more sophisticated language structures and idiomatic expressions, with conversation at the center. Reading selections are varied and authentic — newspapers, magazines, and literary works from the Spanish-speaking world — and writing grows in practical range and polish. As an honors course it carries real rigor: scholars analyze, evaluate, and create with complex material. The year works in the Advanced range: fluent, flexible discussion, formal presentations on literature, and persuasive writing with consistent control of time frames and mood.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

1 Listening (Advanced)

Authentic TV, radio, podcasts, interviews, and presentations — including different accents, idioms, and points of view.

3 Conversation (Advanced)

Fluent, flexible exchange on familiar and unfamiliar topics, formal and informal registers, and handling unexpected situations.

5 Writing (Advanced)

Persuasive essays that sustain and justify arguments, narratives and original pieces with figurative language, and writing adapted to audience.

2 Reading (Advanced)

Newspaper articles, official documents, literary works, and long, complex texts with varied styles and high-frequency idioms.

4 Presenting (Advanced)

Articulate presentations — including formal presentations about literary selections — and research-based, multimedia-supported talks.

6 Culture and Connections (all year)

Contributions of diverse groups in the Spanish-speaking world; registers of language and their cultural meaning; culture studied through its own voices.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Class conducted substantially in Spanish, with daily conversation at the center.
- Authentic reading each week: press, literature, and media from the Spanish-speaking world.
- Regular essays, presentations, and creative pieces with revision and polish.
- Honors-level analysis: registers, idiom, viewpoint, and cultural implication.

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes / week

≈ 50 minutes a day, Monday–Friday

- Daily lesson and practice fill most of the scheduled time.
- Research, essay, and presentation weeks may run longer.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas.
- Headphones and a microphone for listening and speaking work.
- A notebook for vocabulary, idioms, structures, and culture notes.

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, meeting daily on the school's schedule.